

mean, why would I participate fully if I knew I was handicapped and couldn't win in the first place? This mentality has influenced everything from relationships, to finances, to how I behave in business and more.

Now, I could set up a great argument based on nurture and maybe even convince you that this victim-based, not enough, limiting Money Story was fair and even reasonable. Everything from growing up in a working-class suburb to having an inconsistent, somewhat violent childhood, to receiving inappropriate treatment from a trusted adult, to being relentlessly bullied at school, to surviving a terrifying sexual assault in my teens and to making poor financial decisions when going through a divorce—all of these experiences and more could help me make my case. I mean, give me time and I could have you feeling incredibly sorry for me, only, in my case, because of my own shame, I've guarded most of this information and kept it secret so no-one would know. This behaviour and story served me well for so many years, in that they gave me an excuse for when I would sabotage and allowed me legitimate reasons to keep myself small. Both financially and otherwise.

These victim and 'not enough' stories didn't just show up in my unhealthy financial behaviours, because these stories don't always limit themselves to one part of your life. They also showed up in other parts of my life, such as my health, where I developed an eating disorder. In my business they showed up for many years as wanting to play safe, to stay small and to try to be like everyone else. As perpetually comparing myself to others and finding myself wanting, and as constantly chasing bright, shiny things as an avoidance strategy. In my finances they showed up as bingeing and purging with my spending and saving.

But the questions I ended up daring to ask after being tired of my own bullshit for so long were these: Is that pattern of behaviour, is that sabotage loop, is that Money Story serving me? And who is really winning when I choose to hold a victim story or if I believe I'm not enough? That's when I started to take steps to rewrite my Money Story and give myself a brave new ending.

One of my favourite quotes is by Henri Nouwen, a Dutch Catholic priest, writer and theologian. He said, 'There are three lies of identity—I am what I have, I am what I do and I am what other people say or think of